



Reading Comprehension

Ms. Hamna Jafri

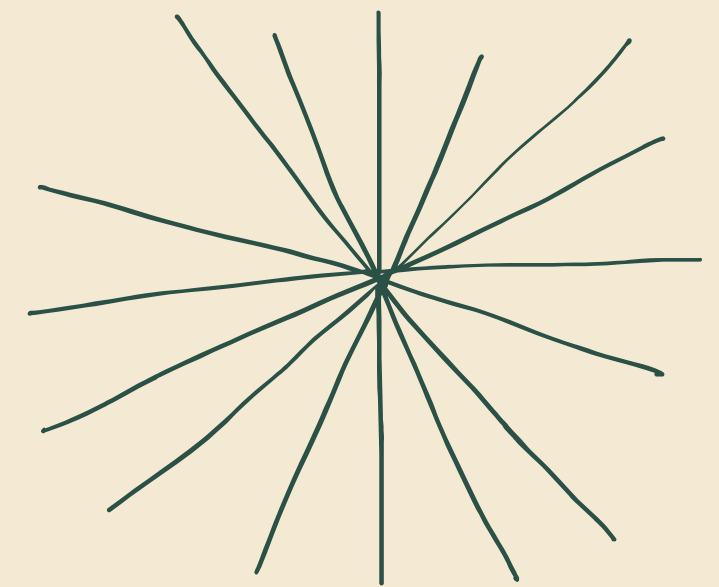
You will be assessed on your ability to:

- demonstrate understanding of explicit meanings
demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes
- analyse, evaluate and develop facts, ideas and opinions, using appropriate support from the text
- demonstrate understanding of how writers achieve effects and influence readers
- select and use information for specific purposes.

Explicit & Implicit Meanings

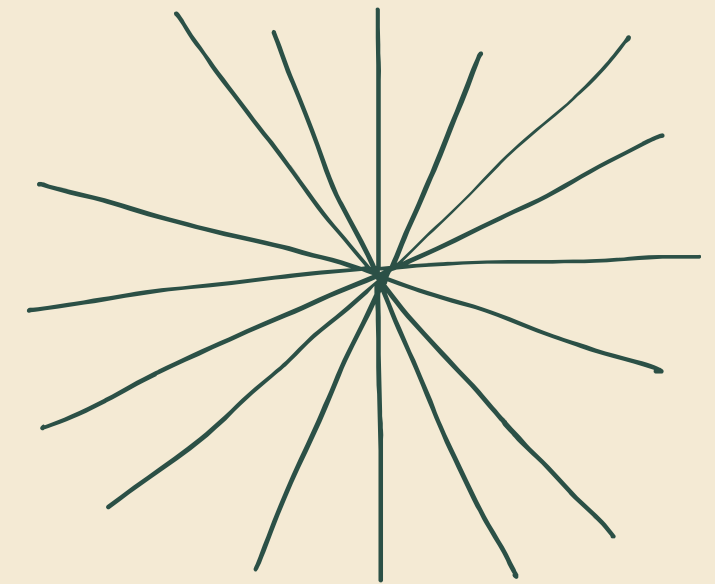
Explicit & implicit meanings

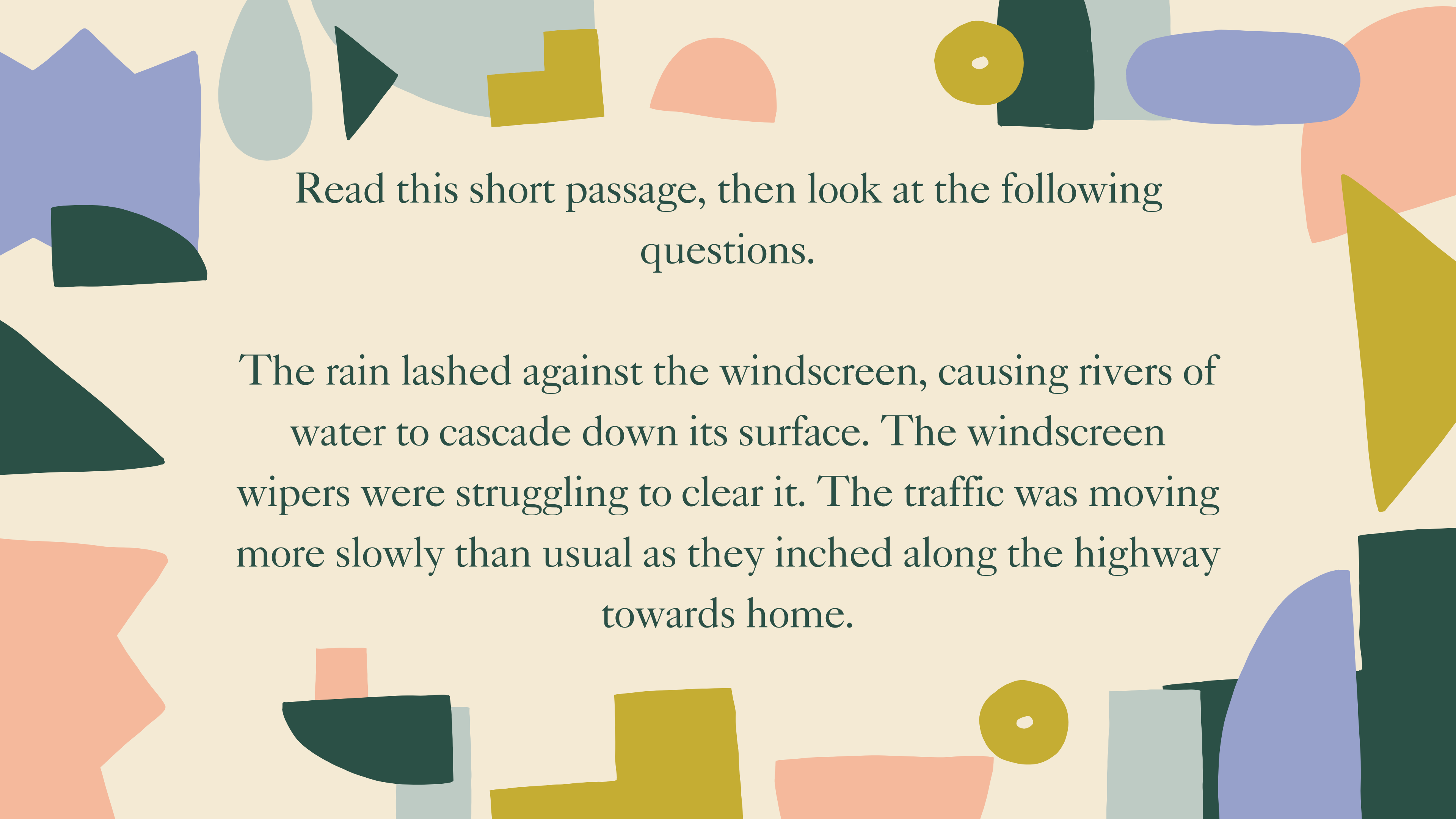
When you demonstrate an understanding of explicit meaning in a text, you show that you have understood its surface meaning: what the writer states directly. This relies on your experience and knowledge of vocabulary, how writers express ideas and opinions, or how they narrate characters and events.



Explicit & implicit meanings

When you demonstrate an implicit understanding of a text, it means you have looked deeper and 'read between the lines' to infer what a writer suggests by their language choice.





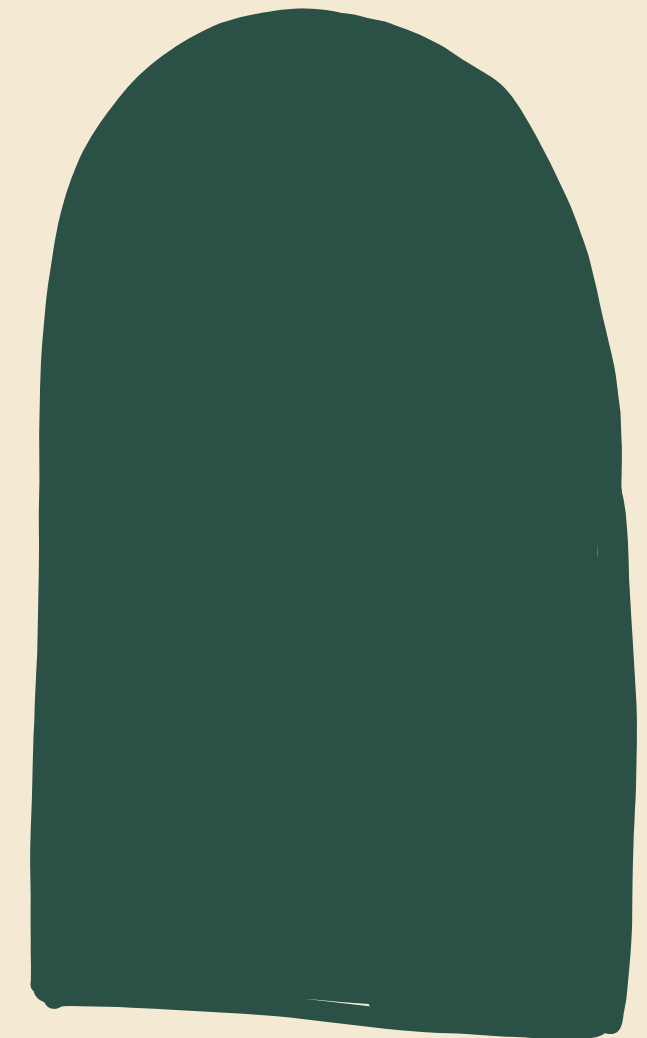
Read this short passage, then look at the following questions.

The rain lashed against the windscreen, causing rivers of water to cascade down its surface. The windscreen wipers were struggling to clear it. The traffic was moving more slowly than usual as they inched along the highway towards home.

Question 1: What was the weather like?

Question 2: Where were they traveling?

Question 3: From the evidence in the text explain why the traffic was moving slower than usual?



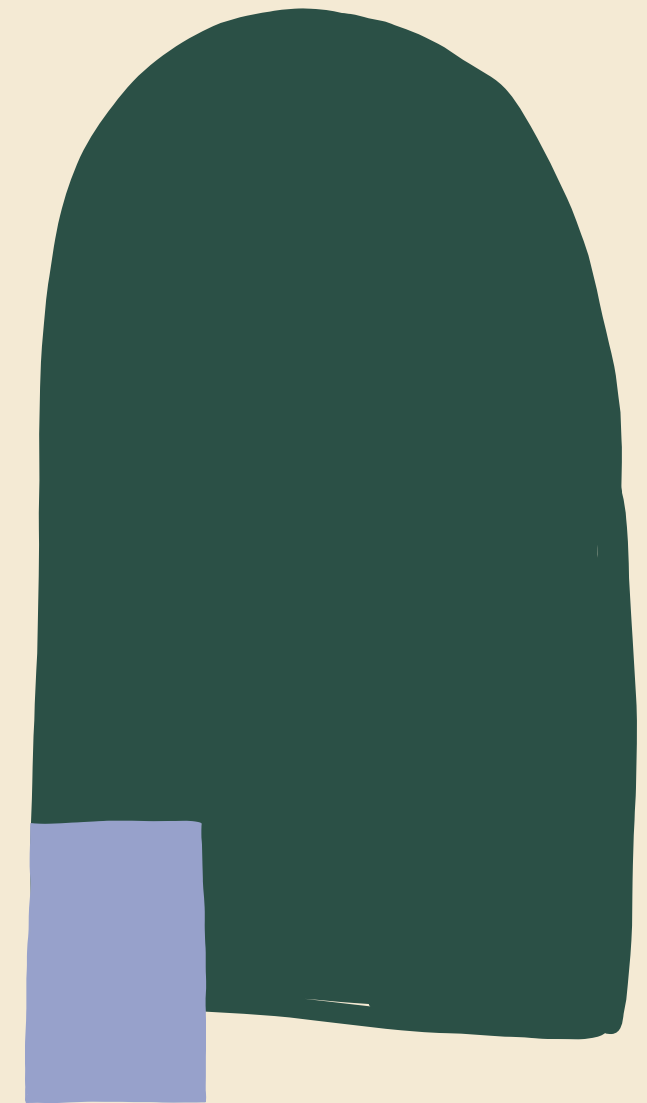
Question 3:

Examples:

A. The traffic was moving more slowly than usual because the heavy rain made visibility poor.

B. The traffic was traveling more slowly than usual because the heavy rain made driving conditions dangerous.

C. The traffic was traveling more slowly than usual because there had been an accident.



Look at this example:

The examinations had gone exactly as expected; his first-choice university beckoned.

Although the first part of the sentence does not explicitly state that the exams have gone well, the second part implies this, because the subject of the sentence seems confident that he has secured a place at his first choice of university. Implying information rather than stating it directly makes the writing more interesting.



Now look at this second example:

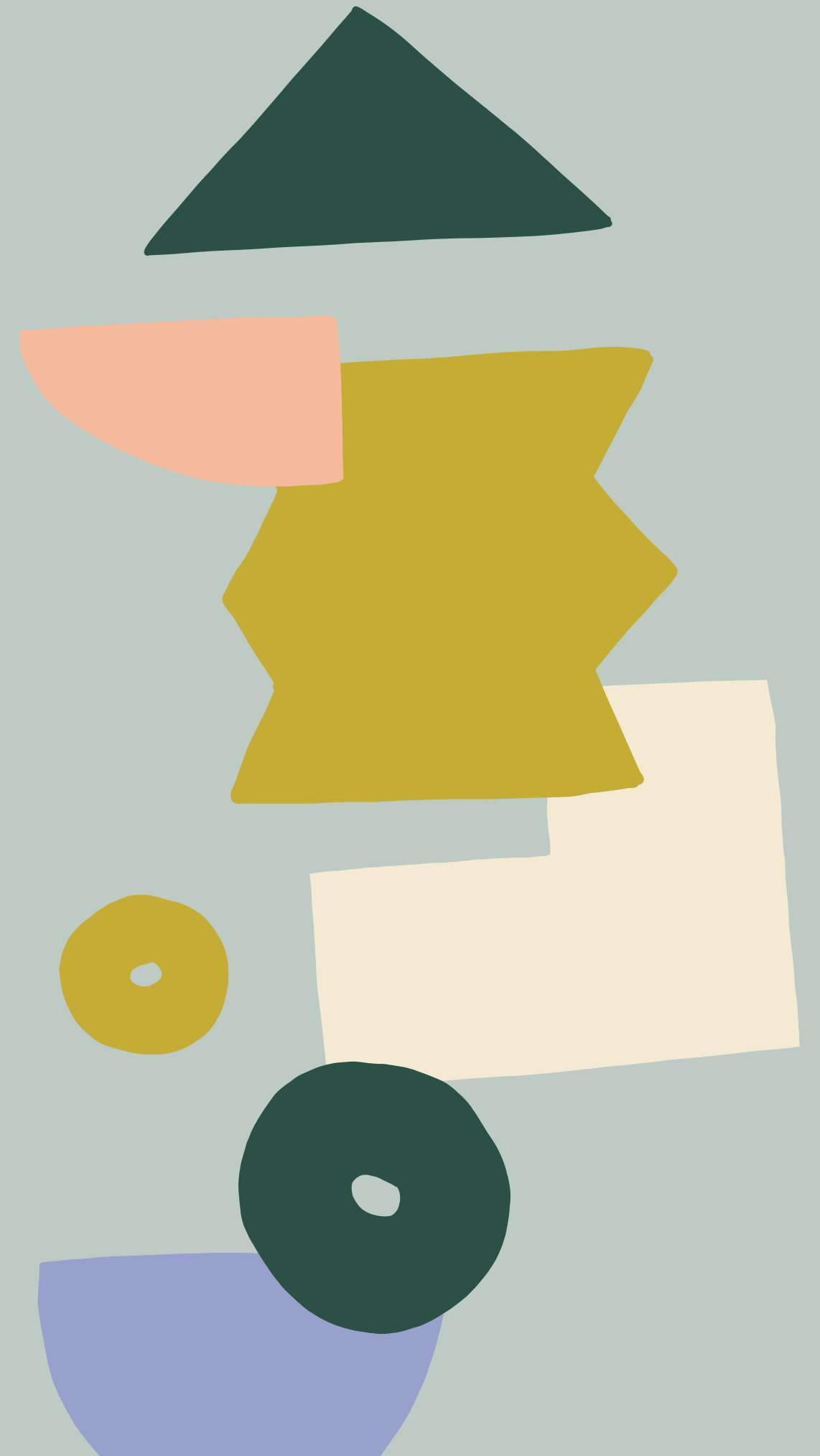
Ali saw his brother across the room and eagerly waved while hurrying towards him, but Mazhar turned away and busied himself in conversation with a friend.

In this sentence the writer implies that Ali is more enthusiastic about seeing Mazhar than Mazhar is to talk to Ali. This suggests that there is some tension , and keeps the reader interested because they do not know why.

*How writers use implicit
meanings for specific
effects*

Writers use implicit meanings in their texts for a number of reasons:

- to make subtle inferences about a character (positive or negative)
- to suggest how a character feels about something
- to suggest the nuances in relationships between characters
- to convey their own opinions or attitudes
- to create suspense, tension or humour.



*Understanding a writer's
opinions and attitudes
(Writer's Effect)*

Some texts may be written in the third person, so the writer's attitude is less apparent. However, the text may imply opinions and attitudes that you will be asked to explore from the evidence offered. To do this, you need to be aware of the following aspects of a text:

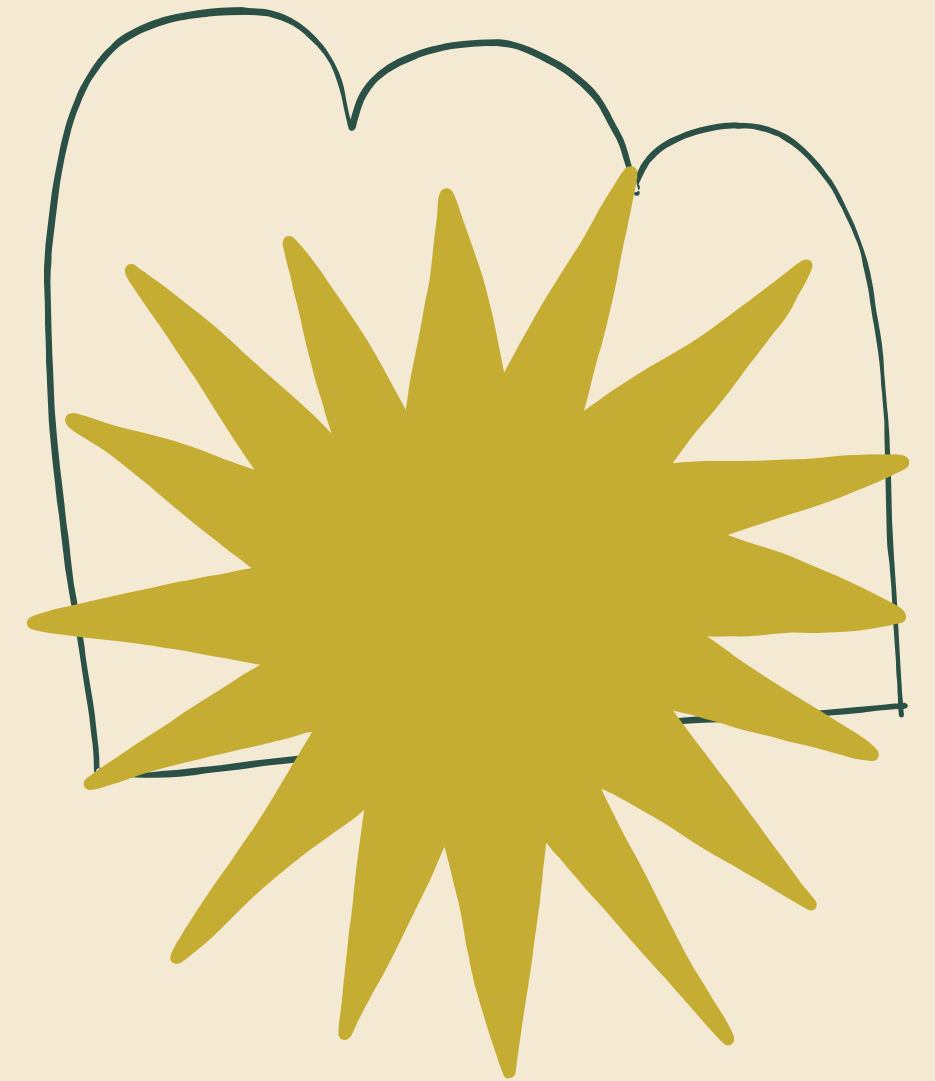
- tone - look for strong feelings, such as anger, frustration or enthusiasm
 - register - consider how formal or informal the writing is
 - word choice - look for emotive language, technical language, strong expressions, deliberate understatement or exaggeration
 - the details, reasons, and evidence offered.
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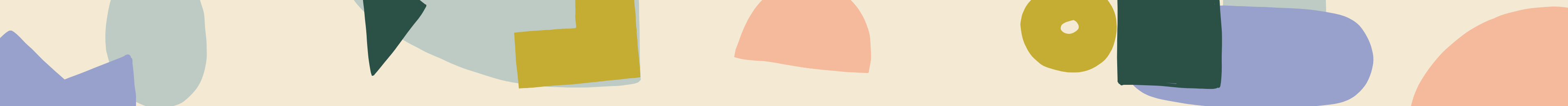
Writers can use interesting language for a variety of reasons, including:

- capturing the reader's attention by using language as a deliberate **hook**
- conveying an emotional response, or a strong attitude or viewpoint
- creating a **sensory image** that draws on the reader's own experiences enhancing the reader's understanding of a character's behaviour or attitudes
- creating a vibrant setting as a backdrop
- creating atmosphere, such as a sense of **foreboding**, **foreshadowing**, or building suspense

*How language suggests
meanings and ideas*

Writers choose words very carefully to maximize the impact of their language. Many words have similar meanings but not all have the same **connotations** or effect. Often, there are subtle differences - **shades of meaning** that are key to the effect the writer is trying to create.





Look at this example of how verb choice changes and adds depth to a character description:

The elderly man walked down the street.

The elderly man shuffled down the street.

The elderly man ambled down the street.

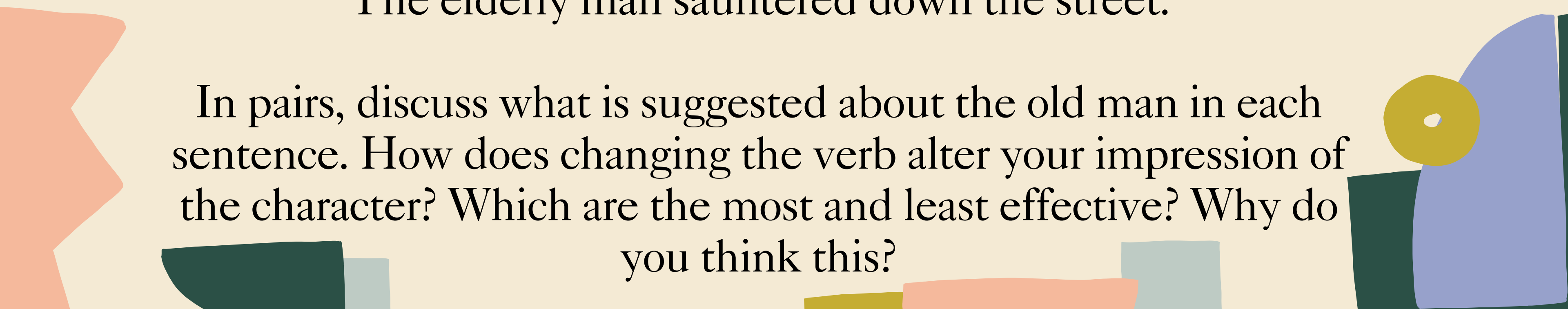
The elderly man strolled down the street.

The elderly man stumbled down the street.

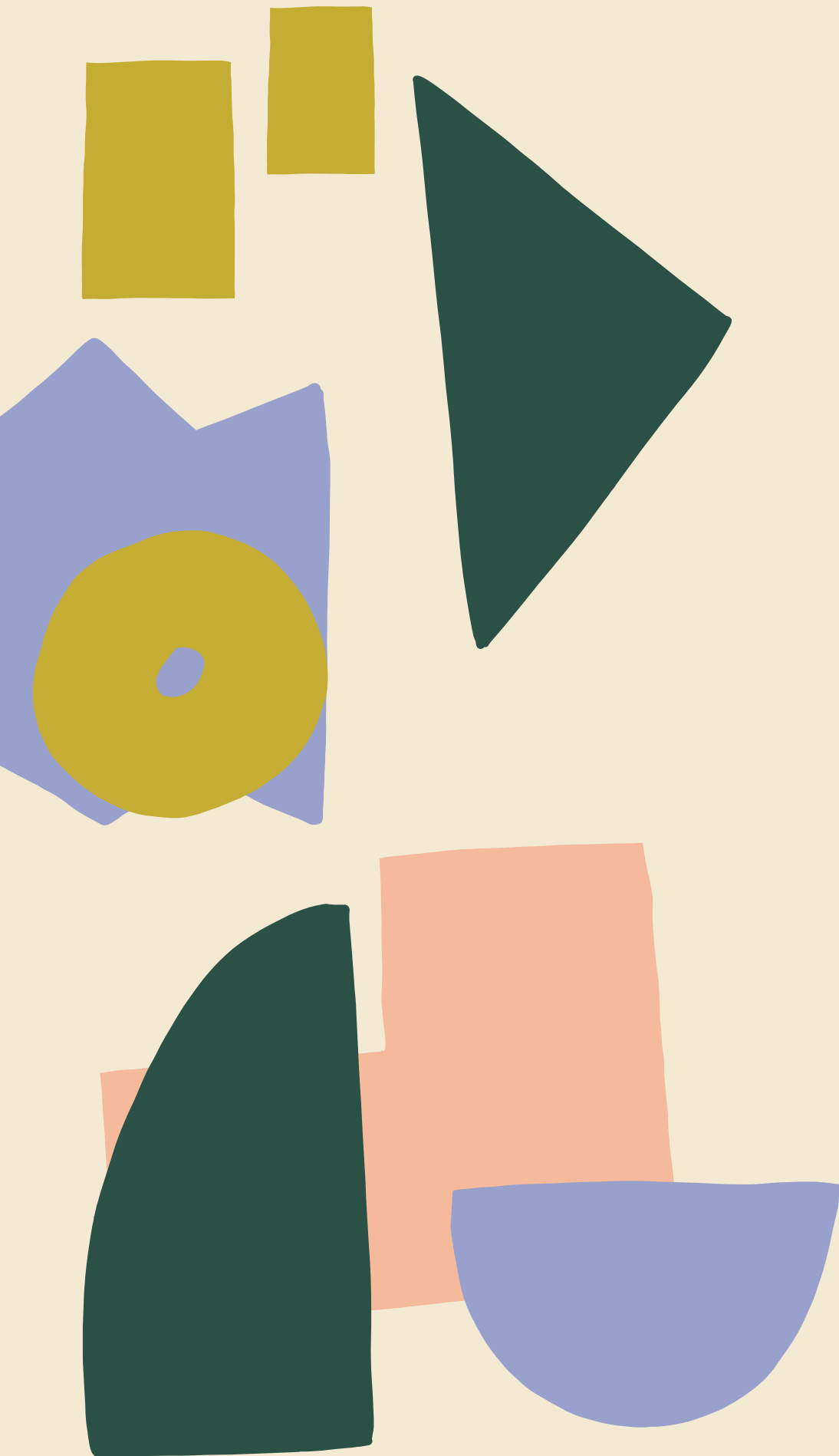
The elderly man strode down the street.

The elderly man sauntered down the street.

In pairs, discuss what is suggested about the old man in each sentence. How does changing the verb alter your impression of the character? Which are the most and least effective? Why do you think this?



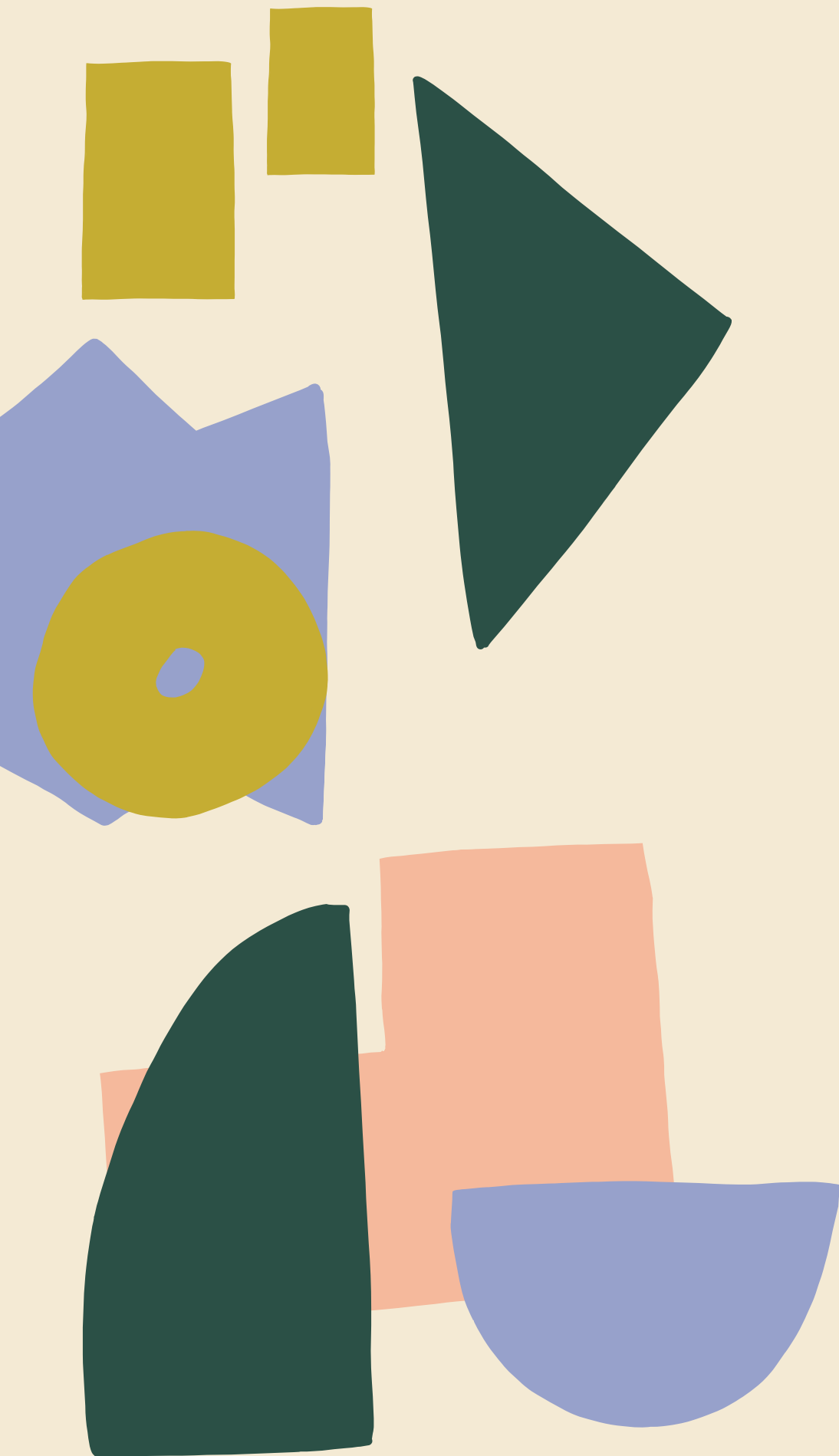
Word Connotations



Connotations are the associations that words have beyond their literal meanings. For example, the word 'blue' is a color, but it is often also used to describe a feeling of sadness as in 'He was feeling blue that day.' So, the word blue has connotations of sadness.

Word	Positive Connotation	Negative Connotation	Neutral Connotation
Thin	Slender, trim, lean	Emaciated, gaunt, scrawny	Narrow, slight
Childlike	Innocent, playful, youthful	Naive, immature, childish	Childish (depending on context)
Extraordinary	Exceptional, amazing, phenomenal	Unusual, strange, bizarre	Remarkable, extraordinary

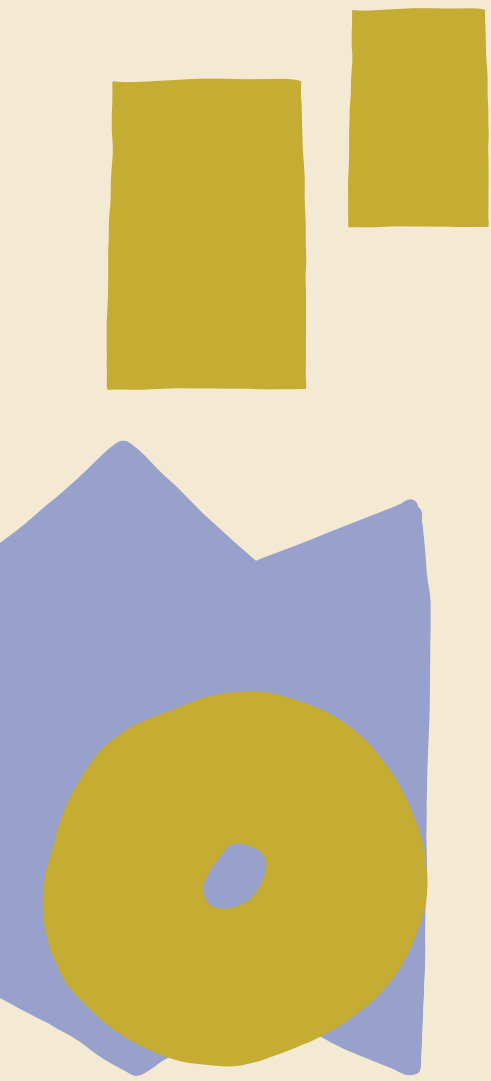
Figurative Language



Figurative language is a type of language that uses figures of speech to create vivid imagery or to convey a meaning other than the literal one. It's often used to make writing more interesting, engaging, and memorable.

Here are some common examples of figurative language:

- Simile: A comparison using "like" or "as."
 - Example: "She is as brave as a lion."
- Metaphor: A comparison that directly equates two unlike things.
 - Example: "He is a rock."
- Personification: Giving human qualities to non-human things.
 - Example: "The wind howled."



- Hyperbole: An exaggeration for dramatic effect.
 - Example: "I've told you a million times."
- Alliteration: The repetition of the same initial sound in words.
 - Example: "She sells seashells by the seashore."
- Onomatopoeia: A word that imitates a sound.
 - Example: "The cat purred."

Laughter is not literally enveloping her, but using this metaphor allows the writer to suggest that she is completely surrounded in laughter, capturing the essence of its ability to spread joy. It creates the effect of abundant happiness. An envelope also protects its contents, which suggests that her happiness provides a protective layer and makes her stronger.

Text 3.4

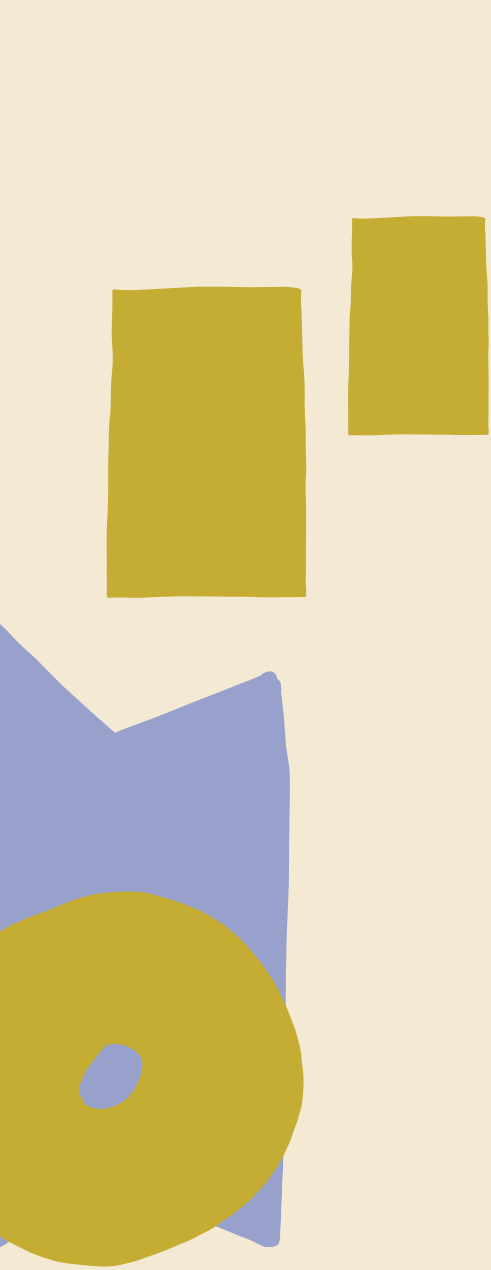
All she could hear was laughter; it enveloped her, like a swirling breeze dancing down a green valley playfully touching everything in its path. She could feel her heart lifting and found herself smiling at the sight in front of her: her family together again after such a long and painful separation. Love radiated from every face as they laughed and hugged and twirled one another around.

Here, the writer uses a simile to compare laughter to a light wind 'dancing', which gives a joyous and carefree effect. The natural setting of a valley gives the impression that the laughter has room to spread, with no obstacles in its path.

Their separation did not cause literal pain, but here the word 'painful' is used to show how intensely difficult it was. The association with physical pain helps the reader understand how very unhappy they felt.

The light-hearted tone continues with the personification of laughter and the idea that it is capable of 'touching' people. This develops the idea of happiness being infectious and that it can spread easily from person-to-person contact.

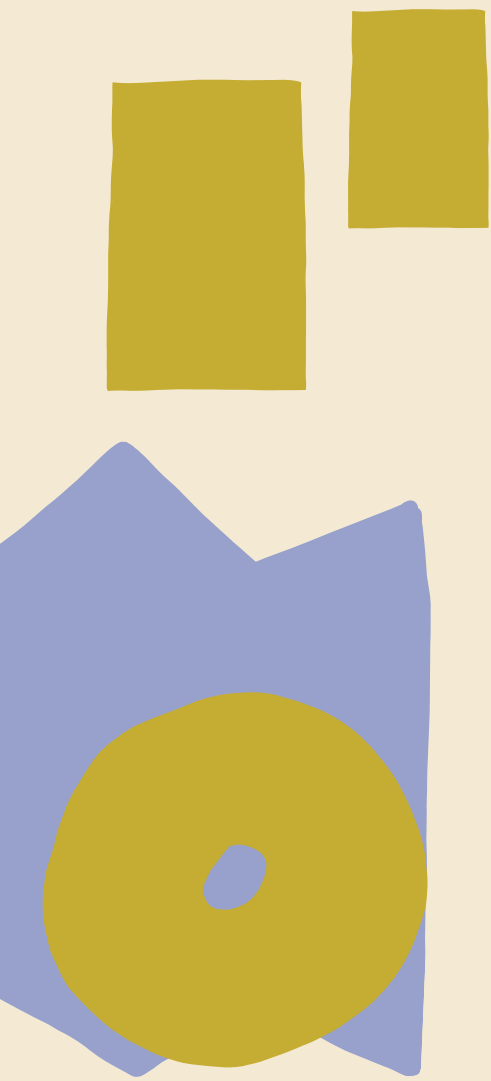
This phrase uses a metaphor – love cannot literally radiate from a person's face. This figurative language is effective at stressing their happy and joyful facial expressions, which stem from seeing their loved ones again. Love is the source of their joy, so the metaphor is effectively used to develop that idea.



Identify the literary devices used in each of these sentences.

- The moon was a ghostly galleon floating across the sky.
- The boy ran down the street, dodging the cars and trucks like a footballer dribbling the ball down the pitch in a world cup final.
- The elderly man's eyes shone with the wisdom and knowledge of millions of years.
- The tree's skeletal arms seemed to be reaching into the inky night sky.
- The young boy groaned, squealed and howled when he didn't get his own way.
- As it slithered softly and slowly towards her, she sensed its presence,
- The rain lashed angrily against the windowpane, as if trying to break the glass.
- He felt as though the world had ended when his mother refused to buy him a new phone.
- He looked as joyous as a spring day when he heard the good news.

Other Types of Questions



- Comment on the ways in which language and style are used to present the
- relationship between ...
- Comment on the ways in which language and style are used to persuade the
- audience to ...
- Comment on the ways in which language and style are used to present the writer's attitude towards ...

Hook: An opening sentence or statement designed to grab the reader's attention so they want to read on.

Sensory image: an image that appeals to the reader's 5 senses

Foreboding: A sense that something bad is going to happen

Foreshadowing: A hint or suggestion of something that happens later.

Connotation: an idea or feeling that a word invokes for a person in addition to its literal or primary meaning.

Shades of meaning: The small differences between words with similar meanings

Thank you
